



## The Passing SPORT SHOW

— By Baz O'Meara

THOSE dedicated die hards who moan mightily that modern hockey lacks the grace, unison and poetic motions of the old time game, would have found little to cavil at in the Canadiens' performance on Saturday night.

This display placed our memory back some years, to a presentation of "Fighting Words" dominated by corpulent Nathan Cohen, and featuring three time-toughened types in Morley Callaghan, Ralph Allen and Andy O'Brien.

At that time Andy outweighed Cohen by a stone or two which was neither here nor there, but his colleagues or opponents of the moment led a frontal attack on present day hockey against the stout defence presented by Sir Andrew.

One of the complaints was that this game lacked the old passing perfection, that it was too haphazard, and one of the twain said it didn't have the ballet like attraction of the old time game. Which was their opinion.

In no game up to Saturday this year have Canadiens shown more smoothness, more deftness on defence, or alertness on attack than they did in eliminating Boston Bruins from the playoff.

No more alluring goals have been presented than those scored by nimble Phil Goyette. The Richard freres double passing play was ballet-like in perfection, in fact it was pas de deux of effort.

The Marshall manoeuvring was a thing of beauty, and a joy for many moments. There may have been an entrechat as well, but if so we wouldn't have recognized it, as our knowledge of ballet wouldn't fill a short paragraph.

There was Plante as spectacular as ever making daring dives and singular sorties, protecting his sovereignty as the king of the custodians and still emerging in a tie with the puissant pretender to his crown, the durable Glenn Hall, whose pretensions were finally quelled in the final game at Boston last night.

All this, and minus two of their stalwarts in the persons of Harvey and Bonin. Their partisans couldn't have asked for a more skillful presentation.